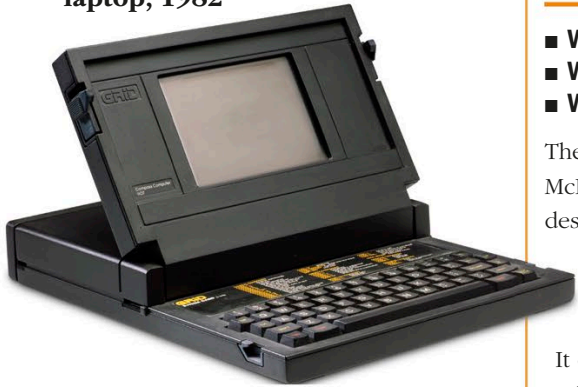


GRiD Compass laptop, 1982



Folding-screen laptop

- **What?** GRiD Compass
- **Who?** GRiD Systems Corporation
- **Where and when?** US, 1982

The first laptop to have the features of a modern laptop—in particular, with a screen that folds flat—came out in 1982. It was very expensive and the main buyer was the US government. The laptops were used by the US Navy, and NASA carried them onboard some Space Shuttle missions.

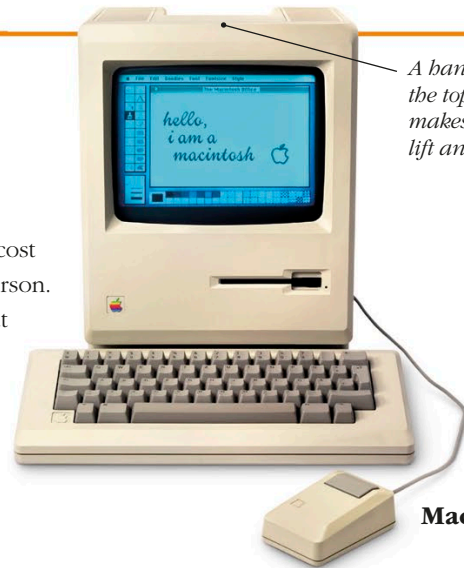
Apple Macintosh

- **What?** Apple Macintosh
- **Who?** Apple
- **Where and when?** US, 1984

The Macintosh (named after the McIntosh variety of apple) was designed as an easy-to-use, low-cost computer for the average person.

It was launched in 1984, but was not actually cheap.

It did not take off until the early 1990s, when Apple launched more price-competitive machines.



A handle built into the top of the case makes it easier to lift and carry.

Apple Macintosh 128k

Touch pad

- **What?** Psion MC 200
- **Who?** Psion
- **Where and when?** UK, 1989

A touch pad is a specialized surface that can track the position and motion of a finger and translate that to the screen. Touch pads are used instead of a mouse and first appeared on a range of laptops made by the British company, Psion.



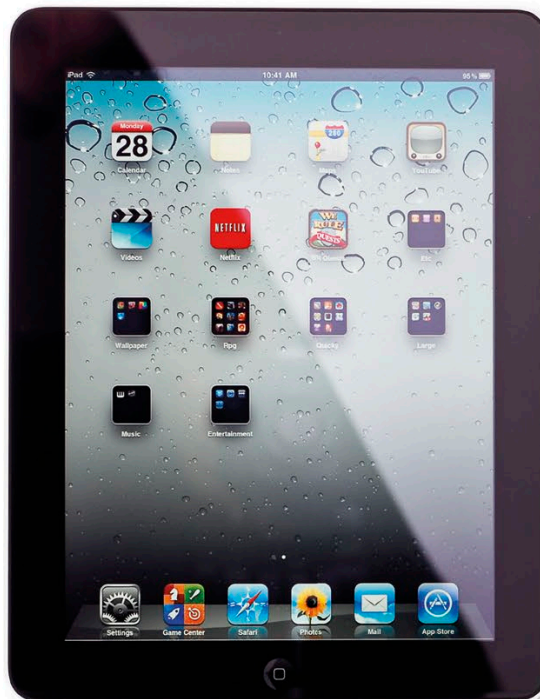
Psion 3a PDA notebook, 1993

Touchscreen revolution

- **What?** Microsoft Tablet PC
- **Who?** Microsoft
- **Where and when?** US, 2002

Many companies worked on the idea of a tablet computer during the 1990s, but the first commercial model was designed by Microsoft and appeared in 2002. It was heavy and not very user-friendly. When Apple released the iPad in 2010, tablets became much more popular, thanks to improved touchscreen technology and lots of cool apps.

Apple iPad



Convertible laptop computer

The 2-in-1 computer

- **What?** Compaq Concerto
- **Who?** Compaq
- **Where and when?** US, 1993

The 2-in-1 portable computer is both a laptop and a tablet. An early version, the Compaq Concerto, was developed in 1993. However, the idea did not catch on until almost 20 years later, when Asus launched the Eee Pad Transformer in 2011.